

Mind Palace

A first-person VR sound narrative about maladaptive daydreaming, everyday repetition, and the clocks hidden inside escape.

Scene 1: The Shift

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factory

playground

platform

concert

clock

Meta Quest 3S | Unity 6 | OpenXR | Sound Installation and Multimedia Project | June 2026

Video can document the work, but the project has to be experienced.

Bilgi Learn submission note: a screen recording can show representative moments, but Mind Palace is designed around first-person embodiment, headset scale, hand action, and spatial audio.

watch

video evidence

wear

headset presence

act

sorting, throwing,
cleaning, composing

feel

the loop become
personal

The assessment object is not only an exported video; it is the performed VR experience.

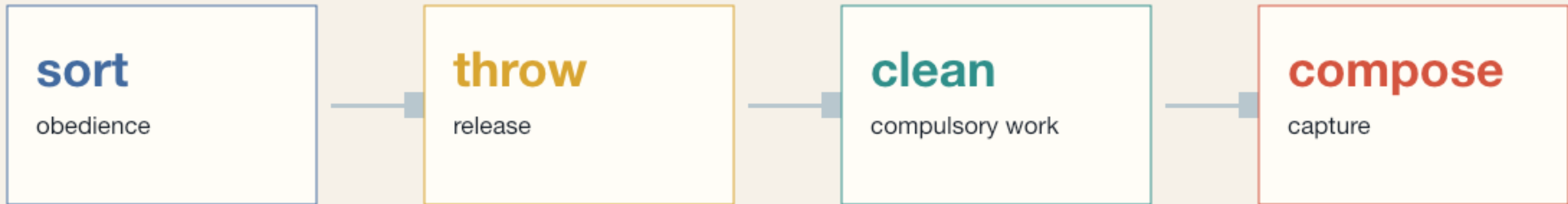
Everyday repetition makes daydreaming necessary.

The mundane, everyday, quotidian work-leisure cycle becomes the pressure that pushes the player toward maladaptive daydreaming.

The fantasy is real relief, but it gradually inherits the same rhythms: chores, transit, spectacle, repetition, clock time.



One repeated gesture changes meaning four times.



The ending is not a cutscene. The player performs the loop that becomes the clock.

The Shift turns obedience into music.

30

standard cubes before anomaly
cubes appear

76 BPM

sample-accurate DSP grid

- machine recordings sliced into ostinatos and tape loops
- correct sorts play quantized pentatonic notes
- green anomaly cube cannot be classified
- second shift returns faster and slightly detuned

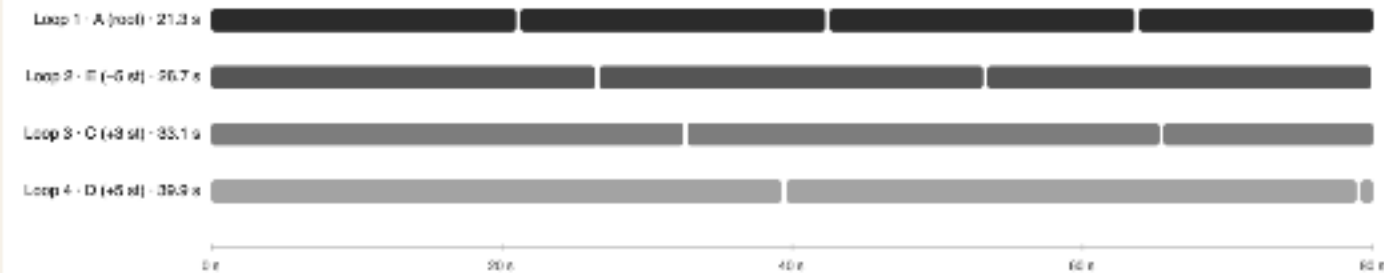
Scene 1 — Factory Score: Ostinato Grid and Incommensurate Tape Loops

Machine ostinato — one bar of 16 sixteenth-steps at 76 BPM (step = 0.197 s)



Percussive transients sliced at runtime from factory machine recordings; root and 18th alternate, octave accent: c beats the bar.

Four tape loops — periods never align (shown over 80 seconds)



Each loop is anchored to a different machine object in the room. Like Music for Asperger, the four periods are incommensurate: the texture never repeats exactly.

Color removes the quota, then repetition breaks the room.



red



blue



green



yellow



purple

Current report correction: the room collapse is visual. The current build does not feature a prominent destruction sound, and the writeup no longer claims one.

The post-collapse transition opens into city rumble and street ambience, without describing passing traffic.

20 wall hits

the playful action becomes a progression system

Routine returns as a metro ensemble and cleaner role.

The player is not volunteering. The scene positions them as a cleaner inside a compulsory work cycle.

- NPCs wander, board, exit, and reset cyclically
- trash deposits add quantized melody notes
- bench pads, rail ostinato, drones, ticks, voices
- 58 BPM A minor pentatonic station grid

Scene 3 — The Station as Ensemble (58 BPM, A minor pentatonic)

Layer	Sound source	Time structure	Pitch content
1 - Rail ostinato	Track objects	16-step grid, sparse hits	Deep metallic A, low register
2 - Bench pads	10 Metalbench objects	Periods 19.7 → 69.8 s, free-running	Pentatonic dyads (table below)
3 - Lamp drone	Fluorescent lighting fixtures	Continuous hum	A2 + E3 + A3 (root, 5th, octave)
4 - Trash-can ticks	Each MetalTrashCan	Sparse 2-step pattern from index	Pentatonic, low register
5 - NPC voices	Each commuter body	Periods 11.8 / 13.7 / 17.9 / 19.3 / 23.7 / 29.8 sHum, murmur, whisper	
6 - Tunnel rumble	Tunnel mouths	Continuous, distance-attenuated	Unpitched low noise
7 - PA announcements	Platform speakers	Triggered by train events + idle timer	TTS speech, ducked mix
8 - Trash melody	Player action (cart deposit)	Quantized to next 16th step	Rising pentatonic line, 2 octaves

Bench dyads (semitones above A3 → pitches):

{0, 7} = A3+E4 {3, 12} = C4+A4 {5, 12} = D4+A4 {7, 16} = E4+C5 {10, 19} = G4+E5

Every layer is scheduled on the same depTime grid but repeats at its own incommensurate period — coherent, never identical, like the commuter cycle itself.

The player's composition is a clock face in disguise.

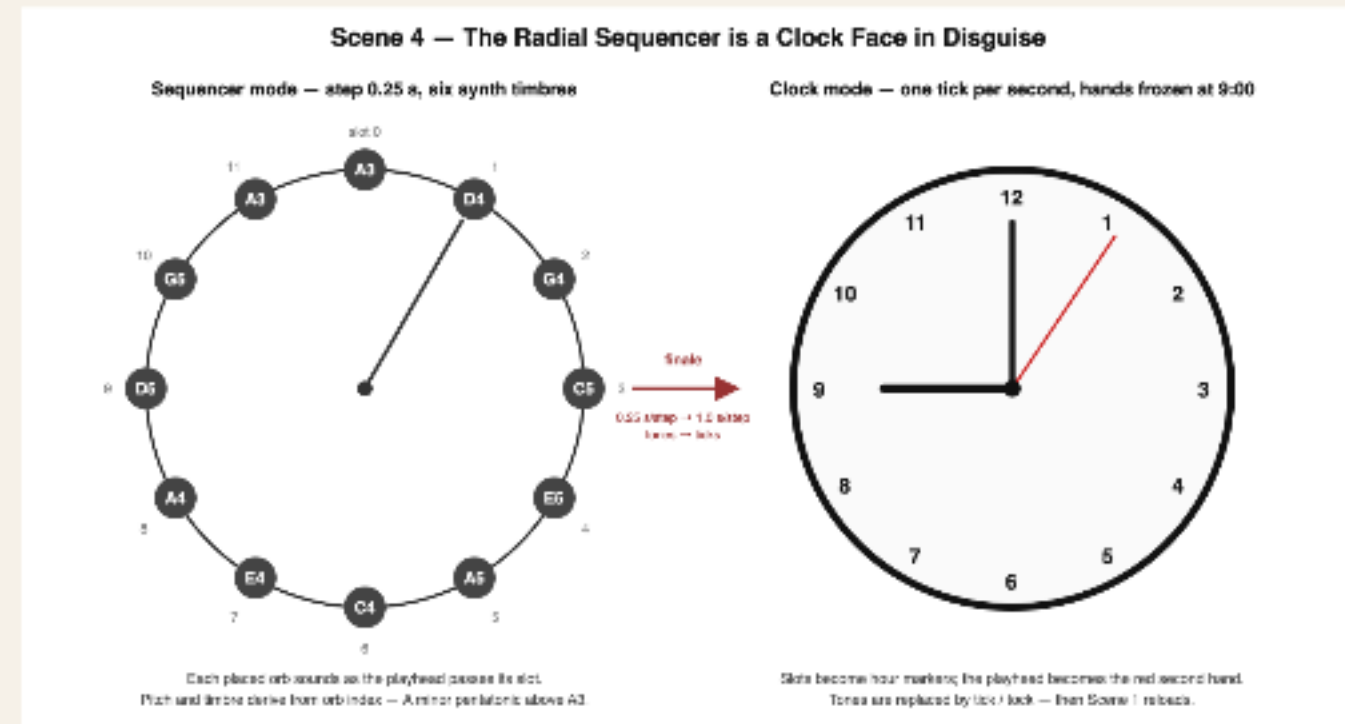
12 slots

each orb removes 1/12 of the concert

0.25s to 1.0s

sequencer slows into clock time

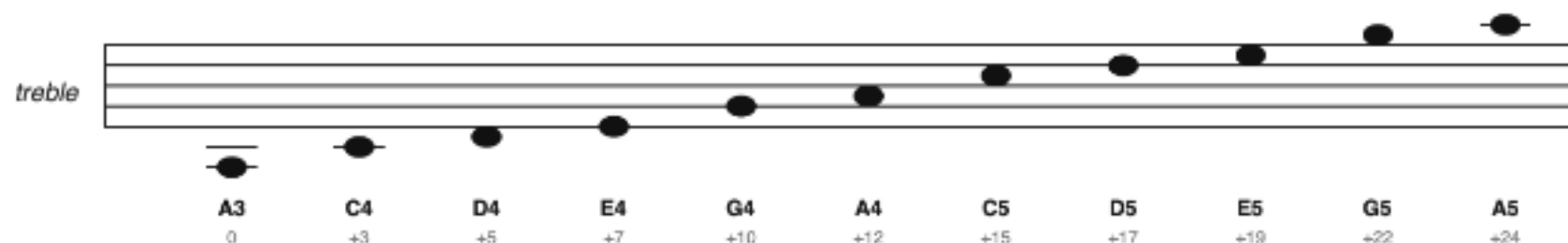
Tones become ticks. The factory reloads at 9:00. The loop is authored by the player, then captures the player.



One pitch reservoir ties the daydream together.

Shared Pitch Reservoir — A Minor Pentatonic, A3 to A5

Semitones above A3 (220 Hz): 0 · 3 · 5 · 7 · 10 · 12 · 15 · 17 · 19 · 22 · 24 — used by the factory melody, metro ensemble, and sequencer orbs



Scene 1 tape loops transpose the same set below the root: A (0), E (-5), C (+3), D (+5). The error buzz is A2 (110 Hz); the lamp drone stacks A2 + E3 + A3.

Scene 1

factory composes; player obeys its grid

Scene 2

player improvises; no global grid

Scene 3

world performs; player joins the ensemble

Scene 4

player composes; loop becomes timekeeper

The implementation connects XR interaction, scene tools, and audio clocks.

XR input

- hands
- controllers
- grab / release / throw

Scene logic

- quota
- wall hits
- train loop
- sequencer

Audio directors

- DSP scheduling
- runtime slicing
- stems
- synthesis

Quest build

- OpenXR
- Android
- VR diagnostics

root-level scenes

runtime scripts

editor tools

project C# lines

MUS 442 turned a contrast study into a circular VR music system.

Narrative

- two scenes became four
- metro replaced old Scene 3
- concert finale became clock reveal

Systems

- cyclic train and NPC boarding
- compulsory cleanup cart
- Scene 4 sequencer, band, audience tools

Sound

- factory and metro generative scores
- city ambience after visual collapse
- DSP-synced concert stems

Device polish

- Quest physics/grab repairs
- LOD, blob shadow, diagnostics
- cross-scene final verification pending

The materials now match the corrected project identity.

Report

MUS442_Final_Report.docx / .pdf

Deck

MUS442_Final_Presentation.pptx

System map

MUS442_Musical_System_Map.docx / .pdf

Bilgi Learn note

video is evidence; headset is the full experience

Final checks before live submission: run full Quest 3S regression, verify Scene 4 serialized setup, complete the loudness pass, and export the final recording.

The influence list now includes **Dancer in the Dark.**

- Somer (2002), Maladaptive Daydreaming
- Marx (1844), Economic and Philosophic Manuscripts
- Breton (1924), Manifesto of Surrealism
- Eno (1978), Ambient 1: Music for Airports
- Radiohead and Epic Games (2021), Kid A Mnesia Exhibition
- von Trier (Director, 2000), Dancer in the Dark [Film]
- Unity and Meta Quest developer documentation

Thank you.

Semiha Paksoy